

The new Android version is likely to take virtual reality (VR) to a whole new level through the Daydream integration. Similarly, it will offer new experiences to enable real apps without their installation on the hardware — using the concept of Android Instant Apps.

Factory images of Android Nougat are expected to go live for Nexus devices very soon. Meanwhile, you can get the new experience on your Google device by downloading the latest Android Developer Preview.

## Adobe announces new open standard for cloud-based digital signatures

Adobe has announced its new open standard to enable cloud-based digital signatures across mobiles and the Web. Through a Cloud Signature Consortium, the new standard will allow users to sign documents digitally from anywhere around the world.

To widen the Cloud Signature Consortium and to expand the open standard in a short span of time, Adobe has partnered with some industry leaders. The consortium is targeting to provide the secure form of electronic signing to more than seven billion mobile devices.



“With more than six billion digital and electronic signature transactions processed each year through Adobe Sign and Adobe Document Cloud, we are

focused on moving the signature industry forward,” said Bryan Lamkin, executive vice president and general manager of digital media, Adobe. The open standard will benefit processes where signer identification is critical. It provides a secure solution to authorise documents when applying for a marriage or business licence as well as gives some social security benefits.

Research firm IDC considers that the new development in the world of digital security will enable best practices for the industry. “An open standard focused on cloud-based digital signatures will not only help companies save time and resources but ultimately move an entire industry forward with best practices that benefit all,” said Melissa Webster, vice president of content and digital media technologies, IDC.

In addition to Adobe, the Cloud Signature Consortium includes members such as trust service providers, academics and security-focused organisations.

The consortium will initially focus on the European Union and then build a global network of industry contributions. Specifications of the new standard are likely to be released by the end of 2016 to kick-start the all-new experience.

## NIIT utilises the MEAN stack to offer Web app development course in India

NIIT has launched a new course in Web app development under its DigiNxt series. The new course is developed through the MEAN stack, which includes a group of open source technologies including MongoDB, Express.js, AngularJS and Node.js. The 14-week course will enable students to develop, test and release Web apps,

## Facebook launches open source Torchnet toolkit to enable new AI experiments

Intending to take artificial intelligence (AI) to new levels, Facebook has launched Torchnet. The open source software toolkit is based on the deep machine learning framework Torch, and will foster rapid and collaborative development of deep learning developments by the Torch community.

Debuted at the International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) in New York, Torchnet uses AI concepts through a series of boilerplate code, key abstractions and reference implementations. The offerings through the toolkit can be combined or reused separately to drive further developments among researchers in the field of deep machine learning.

“We created Torchnet to give researchers clear guidelines on how to set up their code, and boilerplate code that helps them develop more quickly. The modular Torchnet design makes it easy to test a series of coding variants focused around the data set, the data loading process, and the model, as well as optimisation and performance measures,” the Torchnet team members, led by Facebook’s Artificial Research (FAIR) lab, wrote in a blog post.

Torchnet is written in the multi-paradigm programming language, Lua. It is designed to run on any device with a standard x86 chip.

Facebook is not the only tech company that has started viewing deep learning with keen interest. Starting from Amazon and Google to Microsoft, all the leading players are in the race to expand their presence in the world of AI with their offerings. In fact, Twitter is already using the same Torch framework to build machine learning software.